

two-three shipyards. “MDL designed the *Khukri* class corvettes. The designs were passed to GRSE, and with a little bit of handholding, GRSE built the corvettes (an anti-submarine warfare corvette of the same class, *INS Kirpan*, was gifted to the Vietnamese Navy in 2023). We built the capability,” says Rear Admiral Mittal, who has served as the Director of Indian Navy’s Warship Design Bureau and is working for Rekise Marine, which is building autonomous (unmanned) submarines and surface vessels. Following the same template, Goa Shipyard Ltd is building frigates designed for surface, sub-surface and air combat operations. The frigates, built with Russian collaboration under the ‘Make in India’ scheme, are equipped with Brahmos missile system, torpedo launchers, and auxiliary control systems.

Even Larsen & Toubro, which started as a commercial shipyard, wants to get a piece of the burgeoning Indian warship industry. It has proposed a ₹1,100-crore expansion at its Kattupalli shipyard and a modular fab-

rication facility near Chennai to increase utilisation of the existing infrastructure and strengthen shipbuilding and repair capabilities. The Tatas are also entering the shipbuilding industry with their first yard in Kerala.

GOING MODULAR

The biggest hindrance for Indian shipyards in securing large global orders is the low tonnage capability. India’s capacity is just 0.072 million GT (gross tonnage, a standard measure of the overall internal volume), against South Korea’s 20 million and Japan’s nine million.

China’s mega yards can build bulk carriers, LNG tankers and container ships simultaneously. South Korea specialises in high-value LNG carriers and ultra-large container ships, commanding 25-30% global share. Japan focuses on precision engineering, eco-friendly vessels, and niche segments.

In India, instead of one yard building large surface vessels at one go, several smaller shipyards like Chow-

STRATEGIC POLICIES DRIVING YARD ORDERS

INFRASTRUCTURE STATUS FOR LARGE SHIPS

Lowers financing costs, enables priority lending for domestic ship construction

MAKE-IN-INDIA PROCUREMENT

Ships under ₹200 crore to be mandatorily procured from Indian shipyards. Navy/Coast Guard tenders now require participation by Indian yards

COASTAL CABOTAGE

Only India-built ships allowed in coastal & inland waterway operations from 2030. Forces fleet replacement with domestic-built vessels

RIGHT OF FIRST REFUSAL (ROFR)

Indian yards get RoFR in all government tenders for FY27 vessel acquisition plan (₹51 383 crore)

GREEN TUG TRANSITION (GTTP)

₹15,000 crore VGF scheme for green inland vessels. Harit Nauka guidelines for eco-friendly designs. Huge demand for hybrid/ electric builds

INDIA SHIP TECHNOLOGY CENTRE

To reduce reliance on foreign design offices

